



Back to basics

In the late 1800s, miners, farmers, and factory workers in the United States found that their demanding jobs required **resilient clothing**. American tailor Jacob Davis strengthened cotton trousers with metal rivets, while German business partner **LEVI STRAUSS** publicized the new “jeans.” On May 20, 1873, the duo received the patent and this date is considered the *birthday of jeans*.

Style secrets

The tough new workwear was made from a fabric called **DENIM**, said to have originated in the port of Nîmes, France. A woven mix of **blue and white** cotton threads, it is the distinctive weave of the material that makes it so strong. The dark **indigo** dye was perfect for clothes that were not washed very often.

Blue jeans

From humble roots to GLOBAL STYLE ICON, how denim jeans took over the world's wardrobe



How it changed

Jeans have become an enduring fashion fixture—they are the one item of clothing that never goes out of style.

the world

Jeans are named after sailors from Genoa, Italy, who wore tough blue pants.

Forever in blue jeans

The first jeans were so loose that they needed **suspenders** to hold them up. By the mid-20th century, dressing down in denim proved a hit with the **younger generation** thanks to the cowboys of Western movies and pop stars such as **ELVIS PRESLEY** who wore tighter, trendier versions. Today, jeans come in many different cuts and colors.